

FOST TRAINING RULE OF THE ROAD TEST SEPT 16

This test is based on: The International Regulations for Preventing Collisions at Sea (1972) with amendments in force up to December 2009 as detailed in "A Seaman's Guide Pocket Book of The International Regulations for Preventing Collisions at Sea" (BR 453 Supp), ATP1(G) Vol I and the Mariners Handbook (NP100).

The test is designed to be given to any Warfare Officer, Deck officer, Officer undertaking bridge watch-keeping duties or Young Officer/Cadet. The test should be administered under written exam conditions, the results should be recorded in the OOW training records for inspection by FOST navigation staff. The exam should take no longer than 1 hr.

In this test, any change in the status of the ship or of the environment will be indicated in the script. Rules 1 to 19, 34, 35 and Annex IV must be known instinctively for instant application. A thorough knowledge of the other rules is required. The pass mark is 90%.

Part 1

It is September 2016 and you are the OOW in HMS DUNCAN (length 152.4m), deployed to South Atlantic (Atlantic Patrol Tasking), and your ship is going to Punta Arenas (Chile). It is 1200 local and the ship is making its way to port through Patagonia Canals in good visibility.

1. Will the International Rules for the Prevention of Collision at sea still apply to you in the approach canal? Why? R.1(a) (2)

2. Given the good visibility, the Rules of which section of which part apply? R.4 (2)

3. There are a few small vessels all over the Area, showing no shapes, Quote the Rule that defines the word "vessel"? R.3(a) (2)

4. Define 'underway'. R.3(i) (2)

You have a good look through your binoculars and spot a small fishing boat down the bearing and you start to assess whether a risk of collision exists and what actions you should take.

5. What considerations shall be among those taken into account when determining if a risk of collision exists? R.7 (4)

6. What criteria must this vessel fulfil to be considered a *vessel engaged in fishing*? R.3(d) (2)

SSD are closed up in order to prepare the ship to enter an unfamiliar port. You then overhear a VHF conversation between Port Control and a vessel in the vicinity and notice that no-one on the bridge is looking out on the stbd side.

7. The vessel in the vicinity turns out to be a tug on transit (speed approx 5kts) from port to open seas. You notice the tug is displaying a ball / diamond / ball set of shapes. What does this mean? R.27 (2)
8. How is this vessel defined by the rules? R.3(g) (2)
9. What types of vessel are included in this definition? R.3(g) (3)

10. How is 'length of tow' defined? R.24 (3)
11. *You safely pass the Tow vessel and continue with the navigation. You are now in a narrow channel when you notice a small power driven vessel at Green 50 range 1 mile. You assess that she is crossing the narrow channel. What do the rules state about vessels crossing a narrow channel?* R. 9(d) (2)
12. *What other vessels should avoid impeding the safe passage of a vessel which can safely navigate only within a narrow channel or fairway.* R.9 (a)(b) (2)
13. *After a couple of minutes you notice that the visibility is beginning to close in. What do the rules state about speed in or near an area of restricted visibility?* R.19(b) (2)
14. *The navigation lights are now on and when you checked to see if they were burning brightly they appeared to be slightly dimmer than usual. The Yeoman asked you what range the ships navigation lights should be visible.* R.22(a) (3)
15. Your lookout reports hearing a sound signal apparently forward of the beam, but you have nothing on your radar. What do the rules state you should do? R.19(e) (4)

The weather improves (visibility approx 5nm) and you inform your CO about this. As you transit towards the Pilot station area, you notice a large square rigged sailing vessel, proceeding under sail.

16. How do the Rules describe the windward side of a sailing vessel? R.12(b) (1)

17. As the situation with the sailing vessel is being resolved, the SCC request an "Emergency Stop" on both shafts. What condition can you now claim? R.3 (2)

20. What shapes, if any, will you now show? R.27 (1)

21. If a Risk of collision existed between you and the sailing vessel, would this change the situation R.18(b) (2)

22. If this defect had occurred whilst you were in reduced visibility, what sound signal (if any) should you be making? R.35 (1)

The SCC repairs the defect and the port lookout reports the following lights at R10:

		R		
		W		
		R		
		W		
	G		R	
R				G
R				G

23. What type of vessel is this? R.27(d) (3)

24. What sound signal would this vessel make in restricted visibility? R.35 (1)

25. If you needed more time to ascertain the exact developing situation, what would you do? R.8(e) (2)

Finally you reach the Pilot Station Area to embark the Chilen Pilot and your ship berth safely in Punta Arenas ready to enjoy some of the attractiosn of this great port.

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Part 1

It is September 2016 and you are the OOW in HMS DUNCAN (length 152.4m), deployed to South Atlantic (Atlantic Patrol Tasking), and your ship is going to Punta Arenas (Chile). It is 1200 local and the ship is making its way to port through Patagonia Canals in good visibility.

1. Will the International Rules for the Prevention of Collision at sea still apply to you in the approach canal? Why? R.1(a) (2)

These rules shall apply to all vessels upon the high seas and in all waters connected therewith navigable by seagoing vessels

2. Given the good visibility, the Rules of which section of which part apply? R.4

The Rules of Part B (Steering & Sailing Rules) Section I (Conduct of vessels in any condition of visibility)

3. There are a few small vessels all over the Area, showing no shapes, Quote the Rule that defines the word "vessel"? R.3(a) (1)

The word "vessel" includes every description of water craft, including non-displacement craft, WIG craft and seaplanes, used or capable of being use as means of transportation on water.

4. Define 'underway'. R.3(i) (1)

The word "underway" means that a vessel is not at anchor, or made fast to the shore, or aground.

You have a good look through your binoculars and spot a small fishing boat down the bearing and you a start to assess whether a risk of collision exists and what actions you should take.

5. What considerations shall be among those taken into account when determining if a risk of collision exists? R.7 (2)

In determining if Risk of Collision exists the following considerations shall be among those taken into account:

(i) such risk shall be deemed to exist if the compass bearing of an approaching vessel does not appreciably change;

(ii) such risk may sometimes exist even when an appreciable bearing change is evident, particularly when approaching a very large vessel or a Tow or when approaching a vessel at close range.

6. What criteria must this vessel fulfil to be considered a vessel engaged in fishing? R.3(d) (1)

The term 'vessel Engaged in Fishing' means any vessel fishing with nets, lines, trawls or other fishing apparatus which restrict manoeuvrability, but does not include a vessel fishing with trolling lines or other fishing apparatus which do not restrict manoeuvrability.

SSD are closed up in order to prepare the ship to enter an unfamiliar port. You then overhear a VHF conversation between Port Control and a vessel in the vicinity and notice that no-one on the bridge is looking out on the stbd side.

12. The vessel in the vicinity turns out to be a tug on transit (speed approx 5kts) from port to open seas. You notice the tug is displaying a ball / diamond / ball set of shapes. What does this mean? R.27 (1)

A vessel Restricted in her Ability to Manoeuvre

13. How is this vessel defined by the rules? R.3(g) (1)

The term 'vessel Restricted in her Ability to Manoeuvre' means a vessel which from the nature of her work is Restricted in her Ability to Manoeuvre as required by these Rules and is therefore unable to keep out of the way of another vessel.

14. What types of vessel are included in this definition? R.3(g) (3)

The term 'vessel Restricted in her Ability to Manoeuvre' shall include but not be limited to:
(i) a vessel engaged in laying, servicing or picking up a navigation mark, submarine cable or pipeline;
(ii) a vessel engaged in dredging, surveying or underwater operations;
(iii) a vessel engaged in Replenishment or transferring persons, provisions or cargo while underway;
(iv) a vessel engaged in the Launching or Recovery of Aircraft;
(v) a vessel engaged in Mine Clearance operations;
(vi) a vessel engaged in a Towing operation such as severely restricts the Towing vessel and her Tow in their ability of deviate from their course.

15. How is 'length of tow' defined? R.24 (1)

The length of the Tow, measuring from the stern of the Towing vessel to the after end of the Tow

16. You safely pass the Tow vessel and continue with the navigation. You are now in a narrow channel when you notice a small power driven vessel at Green 50 range 1 mile. You assess that she is crossing the narrow channel. What do the rules state about vessels crossing a narrow channel? R. 9(d) (1)

A vessel shall not cross a narrow channel or fairway if such crossing impedes the passage of a vessel which can safely navigate only within such channel or fairway.

12. What other vessels should avoid impeding the safe passage of a vessel which can safely navigate only within a narrow channel or fairway. R.9 (a)(b) (2)

A vessel of less than 20m in length or a sailing vessel shall not impede the passage of a vessel which can safely navigate only within a narrow channel or fairway.

A vessel engaged in fishing shall not impede the passage of any other vessel navigating within a narrow channel or fairway.

13. After a couple of minutes you notice that the visibility is beginning to close in. What do the rules state about speed in or near an area of restricted visibility? R.19(b) (2)

Every vessel shall proceed at a safe speed adapted to the prevailing circumstances and conditions of restricted visibility. A power-driven vessel shall have her engines ready for immediate manoeuvre.

14. The navigation lights are now on and when you checked to see if they were burning brightly they appeared to be slightly dimmer than usual. The Yeoman asked you what range the ships navigation lights should be visible. R.22(a) (3)

In vessels of 50m or more in length,

- ***a masthead light, 6 miles;***
- ***a sidelight, 3 miles;***
- ***a sternlight, 3 miles;***
- ***a towing light, 3 miles;***
- ***a white, red, green or yellow light, 3 miles.***

15. Your lookout reports hearing a sound signal apparently forward of the beam, but you have nothing on your radar. What do the rules state you should do? R.19(e) (2)

Except where it has been determined that a risk of collision does not exist, every vessel which hears apparently forward of her beam the fog signal of another vessel, or which cannot avoid a close quarters situation with another vessel forward of her beam, shall reduce her speed to the minimum she can be kept on course. She shall if necessary take all her way off and in any event navigate with extreme caution until danger of collision is over.(2)

The weather improves (visibility approx 5nm) and you inform your CO about this. As you transit towards the Pilot station area, you notice a large square rigged sailing vessel, proceeding under sail.

16. How do the Rules describe the windward side of a sailing vessel? R.12(b) (1)

The windward side shall be deemed to be the side opposite to that on which the mainsail is carried, or, in the case of a square rigged vessel, the side opposite to that on which the largest fore-and-aft sail is carried.

17. As the situation with the sailing vessel is being resolved, the SCC request an "Emergency Stop" on both shafts. What condition can you now claim? R.3 (1)

This is an exceptional circumstance therefore you are not under command

20. What shapes, if any, will you now show? R.27 (1)

Two black balls in a vertical line

21. If a Risk of collision existed between you and the sailing vessel, would this change the situation R.18(b) (1)

Yes, the sailing vessel shall keep out of the way of a vessel Not Under Command. (1)

22. If this defect had occurred whilst you were in reduced visibility, what sound signal (if any) should you be making? R.35 (1)

A vessel Not Under Command shall sound at intervals of not more than 2 minutes, three blasts in succession, namely one prolonged blast followed by two short blasts.

The SCC repairs the defect and the port lookout reports the following lights at R10:

		R		
		W		
		R		
		W		
	G		R	
R				G
R				G

23. What type of vessel is this? R.27(d) (3)

A PDV over 50m in length, restricted in her ability to manoeuvre, underway, seen from ahead, obstruction exists on her STBD side, safe to pass on her PORT side.

24. What sound signal would this vessel make in restricted visibility? R.35 (1)

A vessel restricted in her ability to manoeuvre shall sound at intervals of not more than 2 minutes three blasts in succession, namely one prolonged blast followed by two short blasts.

25. If you needed more time to ascertain the exact developing situation, what would you do? R.8(e) (1)

If necessary to avoid collision, or to avoid more time to assess the situation, a vessel shall slacken her speed or take all way off by stopping or reversing her means of propulsion.

Finally you reach the Pilot Station Area to embark the Chilen Pilot and your ship berth safely in Punta Arenas ready to enjoy some of the attractionn of this great port.